

PHILLIP KARAYA

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Forward Deployed AI Engineer | RAG · Agents · Evals · MCP

Professional Summary

Forward deployed AI engineer who takes LLM systems from a vague business problem to something running in production, and measures whether it actually works. I build RAG pipelines, AI agents, MCP servers, and the evaluations that keep them honest, on a Python, TypeScript, Next.js, and Supabase stack with the Claude (Anthropic) API. Recent public work: an open-source RAG retrieval evaluation harness that benchmarks lexical vs semantic vs hybrid retrieval on recall, precision, MRR, and nDCG, and an MCP server that exposes those same evaluations as agent tools. Delivered 15+ shipped AI and automation projects across healthcare, real estate, e-commerce, nonprofit, and media, including a multi-clinic practice-management system projected to save 2,000+ admin hours a year. Before engineering I spent a decade in finance and operations, MBA in Finance and former CFO of a major Atlanta technology conference, so I scope work around measurable business outcomes and hand off systems non-technical teams can run after I leave.

Core Competencies

LLM Integration · RAG · AI Evaluation / LLM-as-Judge · AI Agents · Model Context Protocol (MCP) · Workflow Automation · Prompt Engineering · Claude / Anthropic API · Dashboard Design · Internal Tools · Business Process Automation · Client Discovery · Requirements Gathering · Technical Documentation · Runbooks · Stakeholder Communication · Non-Technical Team Training · Financial Analysis · Operations Strategy · Project Delivery

Technical Skills

AI and Automation: Claude, Anthropic API, Claude Code, LLM Workflows, AI Agents, Multi-Agent Orchestration, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Prompt Engineering, RAG, Retrieval Benchmarking (BM25, TF-IDF, dense, hybrid), AI Evaluation / LLM-as-Judge

Development Stack: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Next.js, React, Node.js, Supabase, PostgreSQL, REST APIs

Platforms and Tools: Git, GitHub, Vercel, Cloudflare, Cloudflare Workers AI, WordPress, Zapier, Google Apps Script

Business Systems: Analytics Dashboards, Grant Pipelines, Client Portals, Internal Tools, CRM Workflows, Documentation, SOPs

Certifications: AI Fluency (Anthropic); Claude 101 (Anthropic)

Professional Experience

AI Implementation Consultant | Intellovate AI Inc | Atlanta, GA | Dec 2025–Present

- Built and open-sourced a RAG retrieval evaluation harness (BM25, TF-IDF, dense, hybrid scored on recall, precision, MRR, and nDCG) and an MCP server exposing 5 of those evaluations as agent tools, including an LLM-as-judge that scores answer faithfulness and correctness on Cloudflare Workers AI. Headline result: dense retrieval scored 0.957 nDCG versus 0.829 hybrid and 0.789 BM25.
- Build and deploy AI systems for small businesses and nonprofits, including chatbots, AI agents, workflow automations, dashboards, internal tools, and LLM-powered applications.
- Delivered 15+ shipped AI and automation projects across healthcare, wellness, real estate, nonprofit, e-commerce, and creator/media clients.
- Designed a multi-clinic healthcare practice-management system using Next.js, Supabase, and AI-assisted development workflows, with offline-first functionality projected to save 2,000+ administrative hours annually.
- Built AI-powered lead generation and research workflows for real estate and service businesses, helping teams identify, organize, and act on qualified prospects more efficiently.
- Created analytics dashboards for creator and media clients to consolidate multi-platform performance data and improve visibility into content, audience, and growth metrics.
- Scope client engagements around measurable business outcomes, translating vague operational problems into clear technical requirements, system architecture, and delivery milestones.
- Write runbooks, train non-technical users, and create handoff documentation so client teams can operate and maintain AI systems independently after launch.
- Support clients with AI output verification, workflow testing, quality control, and practical adoption strategies to improve trust and usability.

Founder and Chief Experience Officer | Finance With Phil Inc, 501(c)(3) | Atlanta, GA | 2020–Present

- Founded and scaled a registered financial-literacy nonprofit providing consumer-finance education to students, young adults, and under-resourced communities.
- Organized and delivered 100+ financial-literacy workshops covering budgeting, credit, debt management, investing, career readiness, and financial decision-making.
- Produced educational content reaching 11M+ views across digital platforms, expanding access to practical financial education beyond in-person programming.
- Built the organization's digital infrastructure, including website, analytics dashboard, automated grant pipeline, and online learning community.
- Designed education programs and community initiatives that combine financial literacy, mentorship, career exposure, and practical life skills.
- Manage partnerships, programming, content strategy, volunteer coordination, community engagement, and organizational growth initiatives.

Investment Manager | Karaya Capital Management | Atlanta, GA | 2019–Present

- Evaluate residential development, value-add real estate, and private fund opportunities through market research, deal analysis, and investment performance tracking.

- Analyze portfolio composition, investment performance, market trends, and risk factors to support deal selection and capital allocation decisions.
- Manage investor communications and reporting, translating deal performance, risks, timelines, and market updates into clear stakeholder communication.
- Support capital syndication and deal structuring for private real estate opportunities, including residential developments, value-add flips, and 506(c) real estate funds.
- Maintain high-touch investor relationships through direct communication, performance updates, and ongoing reporting.

Chief Financial Officer | Render Atlanta / RenderATL | Atlanta, GA | 2021–2023

- Served as CFO for a major Atlanta technology conference, leading financial reporting, budgeting, cash-flow planning, and executive financial analysis.
- Owned monthly, quarterly, and annual GAAP financial reporting to improve leadership visibility into revenue, expenses, operating performance, and growth decisions.
- Helped drive 300% gross revenue growth by advising senior leadership on pricing, sponsorship economics, vendor spend, cash flow, and operational strategy.
- Secured \$100K in low-interest financing to support working capital, growth initiatives, and event operations.
- Served on the senior leadership team and advised on financial implications of major business decisions, expansion plans, and operational tradeoffs.

Founder and Financial Consultant | Karaya Consulting LLC | Atlanta, GA | 2018–2025

- Advised individuals, entrepreneurs, and small businesses on budgeting, debt management, business development, digital strategy, and capital readiness.
- Helped clients secure \$3M+ in bank financing by supporting financial preparation, business planning, documentation, and lender-facing materials.
- Supported two e-commerce and SaaS acquisitions totaling approximately \$2.5M through financial analysis, pitch materials, and strategic advisory support.
- Delivered websites, social media systems, ad campaigns, online courses, investor pitch decks, and digital assets for small-business clients.
- Translated client goals into practical business systems, marketing assets, and financial plans that supported growth, funding, and operational clarity.

Graduate Teaching Assistant | Georgia State University | Atlanta, GA | 2019–2021

- Taught Business Analysis (MGS 3100) to 300+ undergraduate students, translating technical and analytical concepts into practical lessons, projects, and applied business cases.
- Improved average exam performance from below 40% to above 80% by redesigning lessons around hands-on projects, varied learning modalities, and real-world examples.
- Built lesson plans, instructional models, and student-engagement tools to reinforce business process thinking, data analysis, and applied decision-making.
- Conducted student-engagement research and supported course delivery, grading, office hours, and classroom instruction.

Selected AI Projects

RAG Evaluation Harness + MCP Server (open source, github.com/phillipkaraya)

- Built a reproducible retrieval benchmark scoring BM25, TF-IDF, dense, and hybrid retrieval on recall, precision, MRR, and nDCG over a labeled corpus, then an MCP server that exposes the same retrieval and metrics core as 5 agent tools.
- Added an LLM-as-judge evaluation layer (faithfulness and correctness scoring) running on Cloudflare Workers AI at near-zero cost, with real measured numbers showing where retrieval failures and generation failures diverge.

Healthcare Practice Management System

- Built a multi-clinic practice-management platform using Next.js, Supabase, and AI-assisted development workflows.
- Designed offline-first workflows, administrative tools, and reporting functionality projected to save 2,000+ staff hours annually.

Real Estate Lead Intelligence Workflow

- Built an AI-powered lead scraping and research workflow to help real estate teams identify prospects, organize opportunities, and prepare outreach.
- Reduced manual research time by automating prospect collection, enrichment, and workflow handoff.

Creator and Media Analytics Dashboards

- Built dashboards that consolidate performance data across multiple platforms for creators and media clients.
- Improved visibility into content performance, audience growth, and engagement trends.

Wellness Spa AI Chatbot

- Built an AI chatbot for a wellness spa to improve customer interaction, service discovery, and front-end inquiry handling.
- Supported client handoff with documentation and training for non-technical team members.

Leadership and Community

Chapter President | US-Africa Chamber of Commerce, Atlanta Chapter | 2021–Present

- Lead chapter initiatives focused on entrepreneurship, business development, economic opportunity, and professional development.
- Designed and operate a free, credential-based AI apprenticeship that places an early-career builder on real client work.

Mentor and Program Lead, College Immersion / RISE | Finance With Phil Inc with Leaks Leadership Foundation | 12+ Years

- Mentored students through college readiness, financial literacy, leadership development, and career exposure programming.
- Helped students pursue college pathways and hosted college tours across Georgia, Alabama, and Florida.
- Led RISE (Rising Individual Students of Excellence) at Maynard Jackson High School for approximately five years.

Boards and Affiliations: Empire Board of Realtist · Atlanta Friendship Initiative · National Black MBA Association

Education

Master of Business Administration, Finance | Georgia State University | Conferred January 2022

Bachelor of Science, Public Health (Minor: Public Policy) | Georgia State University | May 2019

Model African Union, President · GlobeMed, Treasurer